associated business. But the central data team will need the same understanding of a domain multiplied by the number of domains. Such overload makes it unlikely that the central team will understand even a single domain to the degree that the responsible development team does. As a result, the data team cannot tell whether the data is correct, what it actually means, or what specific metrics might mean.

The data mesh paradigm shift calls for decentralization of the responsibility for data—to consider it an actual product. The situation depicted in figure 1.1 can turn into a data mesh if, for example, the development team provides the data product straight to the analysts through a standardized data port. This product could be something as simple as a plain CSV file hosted in the appropriate cloud storage spot, easy for the analyst to access. Take a look at figure 1.2 to see this shift in action.

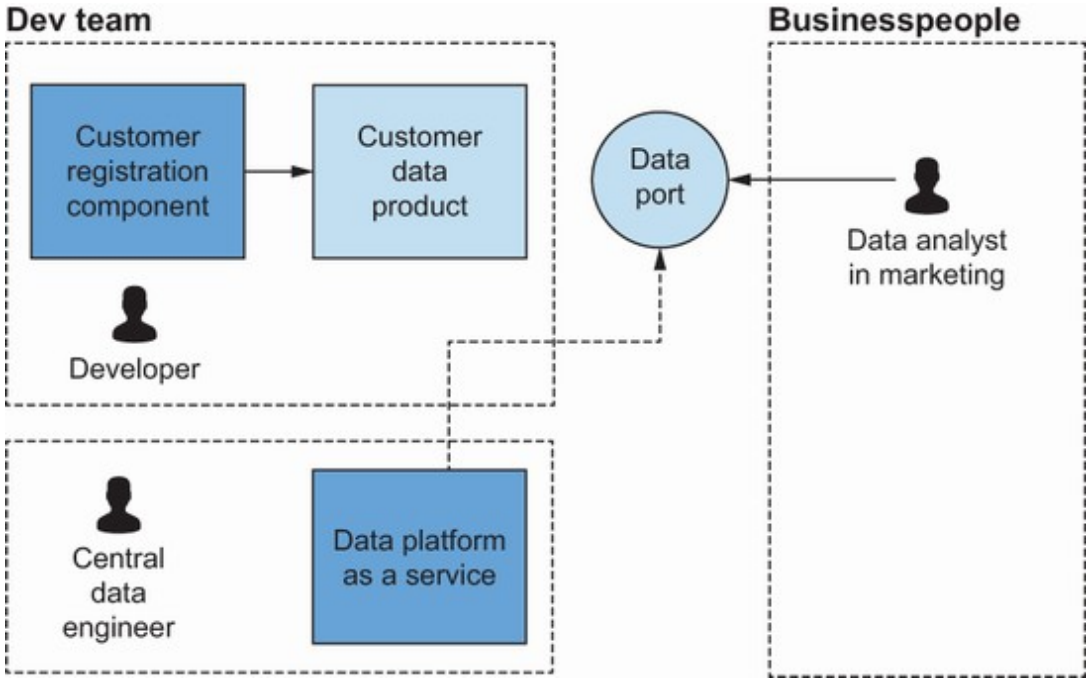


Figure 1.2 Decentralized data transformation makes data consumers happy by offering simple access to well-described data.

A *platform team* could help provide a simple technology as a service to be used by development teams to quickly deploy such data products, including the data ports. Data producers focus on developing *data products*, which,